

Gigawatt PURE Power

Africa – Continental Agro-Energy Hub Platform

AGRO-ENERGY HUBS • LAST-MILE DEPLOYMENT • PAN-AFRICAN PARTNERSHIPS • PRODUCTIVE USES OF RENEWABLE ENERGY

Africa's last-mile energy gap is, above all, a logistics, management and organization problem. PURE Power Africa solves it by overlaying a proven agro-energy hub model onto the institutional infrastructure the continent already has.

PURE Power Africa is the continental scale-up of the operating Gigawatt PURE Power platform in Burundi – the same wheel-and-spoke architecture, zoomed out. A single platform headquarters carries the functions no rural site can afford alone: top-level engineering, procurement and importation, warranty and guarantee management, legal, accounting and government interface. Deployment runs through Africa's own institutions – the member organizations of the **African Agribusiness Incubators Network (AAIN)**, with which a partnership MOU has been executed, and the pan-African pillar institutions already present in every country. The result is speed to deployment with realism: overhead defrayed by infrastructure that already exists, long-term aftercare anchored in organizations that are already there, and productive demand built ahead of the grid, in harmony with Mission 300.

The model	Hub-and-spoke at continental scale: the PURE Power Africa HQ absorbs overhead and provides the aftercare backbone; vetted national lead members deploy and host the hubs; mini-grids follow only once a financial-viability threshold is met in each geography.
Deployment network	Executed partnership MOU with AAIN – African-led and African-owned; 110+ member incubators and enterprise-support organizations across a 54-country network; technical partner of the African Union Commission for incubation.
Pillar institutions	FAO (agriculture, farmer field schools) • WFP (food systems & logistics) • universities (tele-education & training) • pan-African banks and MFIs (hub financial services) • health networks (clinics & tele-health) – illustrative, never exhaustive.
Operating proof	Burundi: 5+ years operating the country's first utility-scale solar IPP under a REGIDESO PPA; Minister of Energy-endorsed 150 MW platform with an active government roadmap; FESEC grant secured with FAO co-funding – ground broken on the first agro-energy hub, August 4, 2026.
Alignment	Mission 300 and the national energy compacts • AU Agenda 2063 • Burundi's 2026 Chairmanship of the African Union as the convening window.
Financing logic	Built to absorb large concessional allocations responsibly – per-country pilot-verify-scale discipline; blended capital welcomed across grants and catalytic funding, concessional and commercial debt, equity, and risk-mitigation instruments.

The problem, reframed

Roughly 600 million Africans remain without electricity, the overwhelming majority in rural, agricultural communities. The challenge is usually described as a technology or financing gap – yet generation is proven, and capital is mobilizing at record scale: Mission 300 alone has connected more than 50 million people in two years and mobilized over US\$ 50 billion. What consistently breaks down at the last mile is deployment: the overhead of engineering, importation, warranties, legal, accounting and government interface that no village-scale site can carry on its own – and the decades-long aftercare that determines whether systems still run years after commissioning. That is a logistics, management and organization problem – and it is solvable, with the right architecture.

The model – one wheel, many spokes, one continent

PURE Power Africa – the HQ. One platform carries the wheel: top-level engineering, procurement and importation, warranty and guarantee management, legal, accounting and government interface – absorbing across the whole network the overhead that has historically killed rural energy economics.

National lead members – the spokes. In each country, deployment runs through vetted, capable member organizations of AAIN – or combinations of them – with pre-existing physical infrastructure: branches, personnel,

government relationships, and living knowledge of local needs, programs, universities and clinics. Hubs are overlaid onto what already stands.

Agro-energy hubs – the last mile. Deployment is bi-phased: hubs establish anchor productive demand first, in a financially responsible and replicable way; mini-grids follow only once a financial-viability threshold is met. In each country the platform selects one pilot region, deploys, works out the kinks, verifies – and only then scales.

Why it works – overhead absorbed, aftercare built in

The historic economics killer of rural energy is fixed overhead spread over small loads. By piggybacking on organizations that already have premises, people and administration, the incremental overhead of each hub approaches the marginal cost of the services it adds – the personnel already exist and can be absorbed in some capacity, rather than hired anew. The same institutions provide the backbone for long-term, responsible aftercare: warranty, guarantee and O&M cover delivered through people who are already on the ground and already trusted. Nothing in the model requires building new institutions; it organizes existing ones around power.

The deployment lattice

The executed AAIN partnership gives the platform an African-led lattice of 110+ member organizations across a 54-country network, with AAIN itself a technical partner of the African Union Commission for incubation. On top of that lattice, the pan-African pillar institutions slot into the verticals they already run – FAO for agriculture and farmer field schools, WFP for food systems and logistics, universities for tele-education, pan-African banks and microfinance institutions for hub financial services, and health networks for clinics and tele-health – with the right institutions brought in region by region, tailored to each geography. ***Gigawatt provides the power, the logistics, the management and the operational anchor – so every partner does what it does best.***

Proven in Burundi

The platform is built on the Gigawatt Global team's development record and carried abroad by the operating Burundi program. In Burundi it has: 5+ years operating the country's first utility-scale solar IPP under a REGIDESO PPA – developed, and still managed, by the platform's team; a 150 MW national platform endorsed by the Minister of Energy, with an active roadmap alongside the Government's appointed committee; Ministry-awarded productive-use concession sites as pilot hubs toward a national roll-out; and a FESEC grant secured with FAO co-funding. On August 4, 2026, ground was broken on the first agro-energy hub at Nyamugari, Cankuzo, together with FAO and provincial government. A contracted agricultural-residue stream powers the platform's waste-to-energy layer – biodigester and biogas pilots underway – while hub e-mobility moves produce to market and cuts post-harvest losses. Burundian industrial and agri-processing capacity sits inside the group, keeping construction, operations and maintenance in-house for the long term.

In harmony with Mission 300 – and the jobs it unlocks

Mission 300 – endorsed by 48 countries and the African Union, with 30 national energy compacts launched – is now connecting people at roughly double its launch pace. The hubs support that momentum from the demand side: by anchoring productive use ahead of grid arrival, they make grid and mini-grid investment bankable and durable, in harmony with the national compacts and local government goals – and they give large allocations, from the World Bank, European partners and the AfDB, a lattice through which to deploy responsibly and fast. The hub team itself stays deliberately compact: the hub is the catalyst, not the job pool. The employment story is the agricultural value chain the hub powers – produce and process; preserve, trade and transport; serve and equip – in economies where agriculture provides most livelihoods. The World Bank sizes Africa's agrifood market at US\$ 1 trillion by 2030, conditional on exactly what the hubs deliver: electricity and irrigation.

Engagement

PURE Power Africa welcomes engagement from the World Bank Group, the African Development Bank, European partners, pan-African institutions, foundations and aligned investors – across grants and catalytic funding, concessional and commercial debt, equity, and risk-mitigation instruments – to take the platform from its operating Burundian base to a continental deployment, country by country and pilot region by pilot region. Burundi's 2026 Chairmanship of the African Union offers the convening moment to launch.

Michael Fichtenberg – Gigawatt Burundi S.A.